Belize, Like a Local

A pocket guide to San Pedro, Ambergris Caye & Caye Caulker

Captain René is Belizean Maya, born in Punta Gorda in southern Belize. He grew up with the sea, the stars and the reef, learning what generations before him had passed down. Get out on the reef before lunch, then come back with salt in your hair and an idea of where to spend the evening.

01 Where to stay

The Palapa House · Boca del Rio, San Pedro. Settle into a beachfront room or suite, then walk the shoreline into town. It's a good base if you want coffee, dinner and a night out within walking distance. For a resort stay with more time by the pool, Chris likes Alaia Belize.

Explore The Palapa House

02 Get out on the water

Hol Chan & Shark Ray Alley. Start with a guided snorkel if you want to see the reef up close. Mexico Rocks is another option to ask Captain René about when you're choosing a route. Chris's pick is René's full-day Beach BBQ charter, with time to snorkel and lunch cooked on the beach.

Secret Beach. Pick the west side of Ambergris Caye for a slower afternoon. If you're going by private boat, ask about leaving time for a swim, a shoreline lunch or a reef stop along the way.

Caye Caulker. Give yourself time ashore. If you're crossing from San Pedro, confirm your ride back before you settle in at The Split.

Explore René's private charter routes

When you’re back ashore

03 Lunch at The Split

The Lazy Lizard · Caye Caulker. Walk to the north end of the village for grilled island fare, a cold drink and a seat by the channel. Leave an extra half hour to watch the boats go by.

See The Lazy Lizard’s menu and events

04 Dinner on the beach

Blue Water Grill · San Pedro. Ask for a beachfront table at SunBreeze Hotel and start with whatever seafood catches your eye. Check the current menu if you’re going for sushi or a special dinner. For a traditional Belizean meal cooked over a fire hearth, try El Fogon.

See Blue Water Grill’s menu and reservations

05 San Pedro after dark

Palapa Bar & Grill · Head out over the water for live music. If your group is north of the bridge, try The Truck Stop for food stalls and evening entertainment. Check the lineups before you head out.

Palapa Bar music • **The Truck Stop lineup**

Make the water day yours

Send René your dates, headcount and the one thing you’d love to do on the water. Solo travelers are welcome. For larger groups, René can arrange a larger boat or additional boats, depending on your date and route.

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Menus, event schedules and crossing times can change. Check directly before you go.